

THE SAMURAI

A samurai warrior in full armor, including a helmet with a large crest and a mask. The warrior is holding a katana and standing against a background of swirling, ethereal energy. The armor is detailed with various plates and straps.

D&D 5E HOMEBREW

ADAPT TO THE FLOW OF COMBAT WITH THIS NEW HOMEBREW MARTIAL CLASS

HOMEBREW CREATED BY SAKIM
REDDIT: U/MEDIOCRE-PHRASE5073

VERSION 1.3

SAMURAI

Standing alone beneath a barren landscape, a human faces down a legion of Orc soldiers with a single blade in hand, his liege, a 10-year old princeling, quivering behind him.

Hidden in the shadows of a mansion's ceiling, an elven spy watches a gathering of lords having a war council, taking notes on their battle strategies. He keeps his set of bizarre equipment close to him, ready to escape at a moment's notice.

Talismans in hand, a dragonborn priest summons spirit animals that hold down a demon-possessed civilian. A blaze of fire suddenly silences the demon's cries, as he finally draws out the creature that's been terrorizing the village.

Beholden by an oath not dissimilar to a knight, Samurai pledge their services to a single individual, devoting their life to their cause. No matter the vast differences in their chosen lord, Samurai undergo a specialized training that focus on a certain set of skills, skills that are sometimes as varied as the lord they choose to serve. Whether skilled warriors who master the art of the blade, subterfuge experts trained in gathering intel and assassination, or learned arcanists who channel divine energy through esoteric implements, Samurai are renowned and respected by their unerring dedication to their craft.

A LOYAL VASSAL

Samurai, more often than not, enter into the service of a lord when they begin their training. Perhaps they're apprenticed into the lord of the land, or a family member has taken them up for training, whichever the case, Samurai spend their early training days working closely with their liege.

Their oath is bound by honor. Thus, they perform their services until their death, and nothing would bring a Samurai greater shame than being dishonorably dismissed. Their master's death is no reason for a Samurai's duty to end either. Most Samurai pass on their services to their master's family, or to someone that their master deems close. A few of them become lords themselves and even fewer settle down and retire.

DISTANT WANDERERS

In an event that a Samurai becomes without a lord, they might prefer to continue their duties on their own, drifting from one place to another, only stopping at an area to replenish their supplies or take a brief respite.

These Samurai are referred to as **Ronin**, someone who finds the way without belonging to one place. They can often be seen living and traveling amongst the commonfolk. Assisting them in times of trouble and defending their villages from bandits and raiders.

These Samurai live a simpler life, but their hearts remain ready for the call of adventure.



MULTICLASSING

You need a Strength and Dexterity of 13 to multiclass in and out of this class

Proficiencies: Light armor, Medium armor, Simple Weapons, Martial Weapons, Calligrapher's Tools, Smith's Tools

SAMURAI WEAPONS

Those who follow the code of the Samurai come from all walks of life, but its true origins lie in an archaic culture that existed long ago. If you wish to create a Samurai that comes from that path, here are some of the names and descriptions of the weapons they choose to wield. Whatever name you use for a Samurai weapon, you can use the game statistics provided for the weapon on the Weapons page of the Player's Handbook.

Name	Description
<i>Bo</i> (Quarterstaff)	A staff made from unfinished hard wood or a flexible wood, such as red or white oak.
<i>Kama</i> (Sickle)	A farming implement similar to a sickle used for reaping crops and also employed as a weapon.
<i>Kanabo</i> (Warhammer)	A spiked or studded two-handed war club.
<i>Katana</i> (Longsword)	A curved, single-edged blade with a circular or squared guard and long grip to accommodate two hands. The trademark weapon of the Samurai.
<i>Kusari-fundo</i> (Flail)	A hand held weapon consisting of a length of chain (kusari) with a weight (fundo) attached to each end of the chain.
<i>Naginata</i> (Glaive)	A pole weapon that consists of a wooden or metal pole with a curved single-edged blade on the end.
<i>Odachi</i> (Greatsword)	A traditionally made <i>katana</i> with a longer and heavier blade.
<i>Otsuchi</i> (Maul)	A large wooden mallet.
<i>Tanto</i> (Dagger)	A dagger that <i>Samurai</i> mostly use as a last resort or self-defense.
<i>Wakizashi</i> (Shortsword)	A smaller version of the <i>katana</i> . Often seen worn as a pair together with the <i>katana</i> called <i>Daisho</i> (Big and Small).
<i>Yari</i> (Spear)	A form of straight headed spear. <i>Yari</i> often have varied points or blades attached to its tip.
<i>Yumi</i> (Longbow)	An asymmetrical bow that's exceptionally tall.



SAMURAI

CLASS FEATURES

As a Samurai, you gain the following class features

HIT POINTS

Hit Dice: 1d10 per samurai level

Hit Points at 1st Level: 10 + your Constitution modifier

Hit Points at Higher Levels: 1d10 (or 6) + your Constitution modifier per samurai level after 1st

PROFICIENCIES

Armor: All armor

Weapons: Simple weapons, martial weapons

Tools: Calligrapher's tools, smith's tools

Saving Throws: Strength, Constitution

Skills: Choose two from Athletics, Acrobatics, Insight, Intimidation, Persuasion, Perception

EQUIPMENT

You start with the following equipment, in addition to the equipment granted by your background:

- (a) scale mail or (b) leather armor, longbow, and 20 arrows
- (a) a longsword and a shortsword or (b) two martial weapons
- (a) a diplomat's pack or (b) an explorer's pack
- (a) calligrapher's tools or (b) smith's tools

STANCE

Your unique training gives you access to Affinities that let you adapt to any situation. On your turn, as a bonus action, you can enter a state of heightened martial acuity called Stance, choosing from one of the Affinities presented below.

For 1 minute, you gain benefits based on the Affinity of your choice, provided that you aren't using a shield. While still in stance, you can switch to a different affinity as a bonus action on your turn.

Heaven - High and mighty, it delivers intense and powerful strikes, designed to cut down even the strongest foes.

- Your weapon damage rolls deal an extra 1d4 damage, which you roll twice when you crit. This damage die increases by one size - e.g. 1d4 to 1d6 - when you use a two handed melee weapon or a longbow to make an attack.

Earth - Sturdy as a rock, maintains a steady and balanced footing, letting you move swiftly across the battlefield.

- Your speed is increased by 10ft.
- When you make a melee attack against a creature, you don't provoke opportunity attacks from that creature for the rest of the turn, whether you hit or not.

Man - Lowly and cautious, favor defensive postures that let you evade or mitigate the damage you receive.

- Whenever you make a Dexterity saving throw while in this stance, you can roll a d4 and add the number rolled to the saving throw.
- You gain a +2 bonus to AC.

The bonuses you gain from your stance increase when you reach certain samurai levels, as shown in the Samurai table.

It ends early if you are knocked unconscious, if you don a shield or if you use a bonus action on your turn to end it.

Once you have entered a Stance the number of times shown for your samurai level in the Stances column of the Samurai table, you must finish a long rest before you can enter a Stance again.

FIRST STEP

At 1st level, your first step is quicker than most. You gain a bonus to your initiative rolls equal to your proficiency bonus.

Starting at 6th level, if you are surprised at the beginning of combat and aren't incapacitated, you can act normally on your first turn, but only if you enter a stance before doing anything else on that turn.

At 13th level, your unmatched speed and discipline gives you advantage on initiative rolls.



AFTERMATH
ARTIST: CARAIDART

THE SAMURAI

Level	Proficiency Bonus	Features	Stances	Heaven	Earth	Man
1st	+2	Stance, First Step	2	1d4	10 ft.	+2
2nd	+2	Elegant Courtier, Fighting Style	2	1d4	10 ft.	+2
3rd	+2	Samurai Discipline	3	1d4	10 ft.	+2
4th	+2	Ability Score Improvement Martial Versatility	3	1d4	10 ft.	+2
5th	+3	Extra Attack, Precise Strike	3	1d6	10 ft.	+3
6th	+3	First Step Improvement, Ascended Stance	4	1d6	15 ft.	+3
7th	+3	Evasion	4	1d6	15 ft.	+3
8th	+3	Ability Score Improvement	4	1d6	15 ft.	+3
9th	+4	Samurai Discipline Feature	4	1d6	15 ft.	+3
10th	+4	Additional Fighting Style	4	1d6	20 ft.	+3
11th	+4	Elegant Courtier Improvement	4	1d8	20 ft.	+4
12th	+4	Ability Score Improvement	5	1d8	20 ft.	+4
13th	+5	First Step Improvement	5	1d8	20 ft.	+4
14th	+5	Unyielding Spirit	5	1d8	25 ft.	+4
15th	+5	Samurai Discipline Feature	5	1d8	25 ft.	+4
16th	+5	Ability Score Improvement	5	1d8	25 ft.	+4
17th	+6	—	5	1d10	25 ft.	+5
18th	+6	Strength Before Death	5	1d10	30 ft.	+5
19th	+6	Ability Score Improvement	5	1d10	30 ft.	+5
20th	+6	Samurai Discipline Feature	Unlimited	1d10	30 ft.	+5

ELEGANT COURTIER

Starting at 2nd level, your discipline and attention to detail allow you to excel in social situations. Whenever you make a Charisma (Persuasion) check, you gain a bonus to the check equal to your Wisdom modifier.

At 11th level, your self-control also causes you to gain proficiency in Wisdom saving throws. If you already have this proficiency, you instead gain proficiency in Intelligence or Charisma saving throws (your choice).

FIGHTING STYLE

At 2nd level, you adopt a particular style of fighting as your specialty. Choose one of the following options. You can't take a Fighting Style option more than once, even if you later get to choose again.

- **Archery:** You gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls you make with ranged weapons.
- **Blind Fighting:** You have blindsight with a range of 10 feet. Within that range, you can effectively see anything that isn't behind total cover, even if you're blinded or in darkness. Moreover, you can see an invisible creature within that range, unless the creature successfully hides from you.
- **Dueling.** When you are wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapons, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.

- **Great Weapon Fighting** When you roll a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack you make with a melee weapon that you are wielding with two hands, you can reroll the die and must use the new roll, even if the new roll is a 1 or a 2. The weapon must have the two-handed or versatile property for you to gain this benefit.
- **Thrown Weapon Fighting.** You can draw a weapon that has the thrown property as part of the attack you make with the weapon. In addition, when you hit with a ranged attack using a thrown weapon, you gain a +2 bonus to the damage roll.
- **Two-Weapon Fighting.** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability modifier to the damage of the second attack.

At 10th level, you can choose an additional Fighting Style.

SAMURAI DISCIPLINE

At 3rd level, you choose the type of School you specialize in. Your choice grants you features at 3rd level and again at 9th, 15th, and 20th level.

ABILITY SCORE IMPROVEMENT

When you reach 4th level, and again at 8th, 12th, 16th, and 19th level, you can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or you can increase two ability scores of your choice by 1. As normal, you can't increase an ability score above 20 using this feature.

MARTIAL VERSATILITY

Whenever you reach a level in this class that grants the Ability Score Improvement feature, you can replace a fighting style you know with another fighting style available to Samurai. This replacement represents a shift of focus in your martial practice.

EXTRA ATTACK

Beginning at 5th level, you can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the Attack action on your turn.

PRECISE STRIKE

Starting at 5th level, when you miss a creature with a weapon attack, you can choose to make your next attack against that creature with advantage.

Once you've used this feature to make an attack hit, you are unable to use it again until you finish a short or long rest.

ASCENDED STANCE

Beginning at 6th level, you can activate an Affinity's **Kai**. For 1 minute, you gain additional benefits while in this Affinity's Stance, along with the features it initially provides.

Heaven Kai: When you deal the additional damage of your Heaven Affinity and the target is incapacitated, prone, or restrained, can roll two dice instead of just one, adding both to the roll.

Earth Kai: When you make a melee weapon attack after moving, you gain a +1 bonus to your attack and damage rolls for every 5 ft. of movement you've spent before that attack, to a maximum of +3. These bonuses reset to 0 after you make the attack, whether you hit or not.

Man Kai: Other creatures provoke an opportunity attack from you when they enter your reach. Additionally, you can temporarily lose the AC granted by this Affinity until the end of your next turn. When you do so, choose a creature within 5 ft. of you. As a bonus action, you can heal that creature a number of hit points equal to twice your Wisdom Modifier (Minimum of 1).

Once you activate any Affinity's **Kai**, you must finish a long rest before you can activate **Kai** again.

EVASION

At 7th level, you can nimbly dodge out of the way of certain area effects, such as a red dragon's fiery breath or an Ice Storm spell. When you are subjected to an effect that allows you to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, you instead take no damage if you succeed on the saving throw, and only half damage if you fail.

UNYIELDING SPIRIT

Starting at 14th level, your strict training allows you to maintain exceptional control over your mind and body, giving you the following benefits.

- You have advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened.
- You have advantage on Strength and Dexterity saving throws.
- You can use your reaction and 5 feet of movement to immediately get back up when you are knocked prone.

STRENGTH BEFORE DEATH

Starting at 18th level, your fighting spirit can delay the grasp of death. If you take damage that reduces you to 0 hit points, you can delay falling unconscious (no action required from you), regain all expended uses of your Stance, and immediately take an extra turn. While you have 0 hit points during that extra turn, taking damage causes death saving throw failures as normal, and three death saving throw failures can still kill you. When the extra turn ends, you fall unconscious if you still have 0 hit points.

Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

BUSHI

Dedicated to their pursuit of weapon mastery, Bushi fight with an implacable fighting spirit to overcome their enemies, relishing each victory and learning from their defeats.

FIGHTING SPIRIT

Starting at 3rd level, your intensity in battle can shield you and help you strike true. When you enter a stance, you can give yourself advantage on all weapon attack rolls until the end of the current turn. When you do so, you also gain 5 temporary hit points. The number of hit points increases when you reach certain levels in this class, increasing to 10 at 10th level and 15 at 15th level.

You can use this feature a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus. You regain all expended uses of it when you finish a long rest.



VAGABOND
ARTIST: CONOR SMITH



SIGNATURE WEAPON

Beginning at 3rd level, you adopt a particular fighting style that makes use of a signature weapon. Choose one of the following options.

Bowmaster: Whenever you have advantage on an attack roll using a longbow, you can reroll one of the dice once. This doesn't stack with other features that grant the same effect, such as the feat **Elven Accuracy**.

Fated pair: You learn how to seamlessly fight with the *Daisho*: a combination of a one-handed melee weapon, and a one-handed, **light** melee weapon. When held in both hands, these weapons give you the following benefits.

- You can draw or stow both weapons when you would normally be able to draw or stow only one.
- When you attack with one of the weapons using the Attack action, you can make one additional attack with the other as part of the same action. You don't add your ability modifier to the damage of the second attack, unless that modifier is negative, or you have the fighting style two-weapon fighting. Attacking in this way makes you unable to attack as a bonus action on that turn.

Master Duelist: When you are wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapons, you gain a +2 bonus to AC. Provided that you are within 5 ft. of a creature and no other creatures are within 5 feet of you.

Mighty Blows: When you hit a creature with a melee weapon that has the **Heavy** property, you can force it to make a Strength or Dexterity saving throw (your choice) or it's knocked prone. The DC is 10 or half the damage of the attack, whichever is higher.

At 15th level, whenever you make an attack with your signature weapon, you gain +1 to its attack and damage rolls.

RAPID STRIKE

Starting at 9th level, you learn to trade accuracy for swift strikes. If you take the Attack action on your turn and have advantage on an attack roll against one of the targets, you can forgo the advantage for that roll to make an additional weapon attack against that target, as part of the same action. You can do so no more than once per turn.

INVINCIBLE UNDER THE SUN

At 20th level, your mastery with weapons has reached its peak. You can enter a special stance called **Kensei** - A culmination of all the battle experience you've accumulated over the years. You can weave in and out of this stance for 1 minute, and it gives you the following benefits:

- The number of attacks you can make with **Extra Attack** increases to three.
- Your melee weapon attacks score a critical hit on a roll of 18-20.
- You gain resistance to all damage.

Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

SAMURAI GIRL

ARTIST: RIVER FLOW SHORE

SHINOBI

Shinobi are elite agents and spies trained in infiltration and reconnaissance. Despite being mostly known for their shadowy disposition, Shinobi can quickly employ a variety of tools and weapons to make a quick escape or turn the tides of battle.

INFILTRATOR

Beginning at 3rd level, you gain knowledge on how to best utilize your skills for espionage and subterfuge. While wearing light or no armor, you gain the following benefits:

- You gain proficiency in the stealth skill and thieves' tools if you don't already have it. Your proficiency bonus is doubled for any ability check you make that uses either of those proficiencies.
- You gain darkvision out to a range of 60 feet. If you already have darkvision from your race, its range increases by 30 feet.
- You have a climbing speed equal to your walking speed.

GUERRILLA WARFARE

Starting at 3rd level, your Shinobi training gives you access to Shinobi Implements: specialized tools that assist you in escaping, or fighting.

Saving Throws. Some of your implements require your target to make a saving throw to resist its effects. The saving throw DC is calculated as follows:

Implement save DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Strength or Dexterity modifier (your choice)

Additionally, when you use poisons that force a creature to make a saving throw, it uses your Implement save DC if its higher than the poison's save DC.

SHINOBI IMPLEMENTS

Kusarigama - a type of weapon that consists of a *kama* (sickle) on a *kusari-fundo* (flail).

Shuriken - a type of weapon similar to a dart that can be easily concealed and produced.

Bombs You've learned how to modify bombs to debilitating effect. You gain access to the following options whenever you create a bomb.

- **Smoke bomb:** As an action, you can throw the bomb up to 20 feet, exploding it on impact. The explosion creates a 20-foot-radius sphere of thick smoke. The sphere spreads around corners, and its area is heavily obscured. It lasts for 1 minute or until a wind of moderate or greater speed (at least 10 miles per hour) disperses it.
- **Gunpowder Bomb:** As an action, a character can light this bomb and throw it at a point up to 60 feet away. Each creature within 5 feet of that point must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw against your Implement save DC or take 3d6 fire damage, half as much damage if they succeed.





You've also learned how to produce these weapons yourself: with smith's tools and 1gp worth of materials in hand, you can create a number of *shuriken* and *bombs* equal to your proficiency bonus in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of you. The materials used can be those you find or scavenge in an adventuring day, such as metal from a foe's weapon or a spellcaster's component pouch. You can also craft a *kusarigama* in this way using 5 gp worth of materials.

This process requires 1 hour of uninterrupted work, which can coincide with a short or long rest. *Shurikens* and *bombs* acquired in this way are made with cheap and expendable materials. You can only have a total number of *shuriken* and *bombs* equal to twice your proficiency bonus at all times.

At 20th level, you can hold an unlimited number of *shuriken* and *bombs*.

SHINOBI WEAPONS

Weapon	Cost	Damage	Weight	Properties
<i>Kusarigama</i>	5 gp	1d6 slashing(<i>kama</i>), 1d4 bludgeoning(ball and chain)	5 lb.	Finesse, light, reach(ball and chain), special
<i>Shuriken</i>	1 sp	1d4 piercing	1/4 lb.	Finesse, thrown (range 20/60), special

SPECIAL PROPERTIES

***Kusarigama*:** A Large or smaller creature hit by the ball and chain part of the *kusarigama* is Grappled(escape DC equals your **Implement save DC**). Until this grapple ends, the target is Restrained, and the *kusarigama* can't be used to attack another target.

***Shuriken*:** When you are hidden from a creature and miss it with an attack with this weapon, making the attack doesn't reveal your position. You can draw this weapon as part of the attack you make with it.

When you later gain the **Extra Attack** feature, you can throw a bomb or *shuriken* in place of one of those attacks.

CLOAK OF SHADOWS

By 9th level, you have learned to become one with the shadows. When you are in an area of dim light or darkness, you can use your action to become invisible. You remain invisible until you make an attack, cast a spell, or are in an area of bright light.

You are also adept at evading creatures that rely on darkvision. While in darkness, you are invisible to any creature that relies on darkvision to see you in that darkness.

VANISH

Starting at 9th level, you can use the Hide action as part of the bonus action you use to enter a stance, or as a bonus action on your turn. Also, you can't be tracked by nonmagical means, unless you choose to leave a trail.

POTENT NINJUTSU

At 15th level, you have mastered the use of your Shinobi arts. Your Shinobi weapons are improved while you are in stance:

- Your ***Shuriken***'s damage die turn into a d6.
- The duration of your **Smoke bomb** increases to 10 minutes.
- The radius of your **Fire Bomb** increases to 15 ft.

MASTER OF SHADOWS

At 20th level, you manage to masterfully integrate *Ninjutsu* with your stances. You can enter a special stance called **Kage**, which lets you move like the wind and confuse opponents. You can weave in and out of this stance for 1 minute, and it gives you the following benefits:

- Your movement doesn't provoke opportunity attacks and you can dash as a bonus action on each of your turns.
- Whenever you damage a creature with piercing or slashing damage, they must make a Constitution saving throw against your **Implement** save DC or become Marked for Death. The next time you hit the marked creature with an attack that deals piercing or slashing damage, the creature has vulnerability to all of that attack's damage, and then the mark ends. You can mark a creature only once per turn.
- Creatures who rely on sight have disadvantage on attack rolls against you.

Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

ONMYOJI

Though most samurai dedicate their life mastering the weapon arts, Onmyoji prefer to augment their martial capabilities with blessings from the divine. Through esoteric rituals and arcane talismans, Onmyoji are able to channel the will of their god in small but effective quantities. Their close connection to the spirit world also allow them to summon *shikigami*, beast familiars formed from talismans, and fight alongside them in combat.

SPELLCASTING

When you reach 3rd level, you've learned how to channel divine energy through talismans.

CANTRIPS

You learn two cantrips of your choice from the cleric spell list. You learn an additional cleric cantrip of your choice at 10th level.

SPELL SLOTS

The Onmyoji Spellcasting table shows how many spell slots you have to cast your spells of 1st level and higher. To cast one of these spells, you must expend a slot of the spell's level or higher. You regain all expended spell slots when you finish a long rest. For example, if you know the 1st-level spell *Healing Word* and have a 1st-level and a 2nd-level spell slot available, you can cast *Healing Word* using either slot.

SPILLS KNOWN OF 1ST LEVEL AND HIGHER

You know three 1st-level cleric spells of your choice, two of which you must choose from the divination and evocation spells on the cleric spell list, or it has the ritual tag.



The Spells Known column of the Onmyoji Spellcasting table shows when you learn more cleric spells of 1st level or higher. Each of these spells must have the ritual tag, or be a divination or evocation spell of your choice, and must be of a level for which you have spell slots. For instance, when you reach 7th level in this class, you can learn one new spell of 1st or 2nd level. The spells you learn at 8th, 14th, and 20th level can come from any school of magic. Whenever you gain a level in this class, you can replace one of the cleric spells you know with another spell of your choice from the cleric spell list. The new spell must be of a level for which you have spell slots, and it must be a divination or evocation spell or has the ritual tag, unless you're replacing the spell you gained at 3rd, 8th, 14th, or 20th level from any school of magic.

SPELLCASTING ABILITY

Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for your cleric spells, since you learn your spells through prayer and meditation. You use your Wisdom whenever a spell refers to your spellcasting ability. In addition, you use your Wisdom modifier when setting the saving throw DC for a cleric spell you cast and when making an attack roll with one.

Spell save DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Wisdom modifier

Spell attack modifier = your proficiency bonus + your Wisdom modifier

RITUAL CASTING

You can cast a cleric spell as a ritual if the spell is known to you.

ONMYODO MAGIC

Beginning at 3rd level, you've learned how to magically produce the material components needed for your cleric spells through ritual and prayer: with calligrapher's tools in hand, you can magically create a number of talismans equal to your proficiency bonus in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of you. These talismans count as material components for your cleric spells, which are always consumed.

This process requires 1 hour of uninterrupted work, which can coincide with a short or long rest. You can only have a total number of talismans equal to half your samurai level plus your wisdom modifier at all times.



COM: RENEVENE
ARTIST: CAROTA17

ONMYOJI SPELLCASTING SPELL SLOTS PER LEVEL

Samurai Level	Cantrips Known	Spells Known	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
3rd	2	3	2	-	-	-
4th	2	4	3	-	-	-
5th	2	4	3	-	-	-
6th	2	4	3	-	-	-
7th	2	5	4	2	-	-
8th	2	6	4	2	-	-
9th	2	6	4	2	-	-
10th	3	7	4	3	-	-
11th	3	8	4	3	-	-
12th	3	8	4	3	-	-
13th	3	9	4	3	2	-
14th	3	10	4	3	2	-
15th	3	10	4	3	2	-
16th	3	11	4	3	3	-
17th	3	11	4	3	3	-
18th	3	11	4	3	3	-
19th	3	12	4	3	3	1
20th	3	13	4	3	3	1

SUMMON SHIKIGAMI

At 3rd level, you learn how to enlist the aid of *shikigami*, powerful spirits that take on animal forms.

You learn the Find Familiar spell and can cast it as a ritual. The spell doesn't count against your number of Spells known.

When you cast the spell, you can choose one of the normal forms for your familiar or one of the following Special forms: Dire Wolf, Tiger, or Warhorse.

If you chose one of the special forms and it dies, you must finish a long rest before you can summon a *shikigami* from that list again.

When you cast a spell, you can command the Familiar to make an Attack as a bonus action. Additionally, you can sacrifice one of your attacks when you take the Attack action to command your familiar to take the Attack action.



SHIKIGAMI MASTER

Starting at 9th level, you infuse your *Shikigami* with a measure of your divine power, granting the creature the following benefits:

- The *Shikigami* gains either a flying speed or a swimming speed (your choice) of 40 feet.
- As a bonus action or when you enter Stance, you can command the familiar to take the Attack action.
- The familiar's weapon attacks are considered magical for the purpose of overcoming immunity and resistance to nonmagical attacks.
- You add your proficiency bonus to the *Shikigami*'s AC, attack rolls, and damage rolls, as well as to any saving throws and skills it is proficient in.
- Its hit point maximum is increased by an amount equal to your Wisdom Modifier + 3 times your Samurai level.

SPIRIT BARRIER

At 15th level, you can use your talismans to protect yourself or other creatures from harm.

As a reaction when you, your *shikigami*, or another creature within 10 ft. of you takes damage, you can create a barrier around yourself or them, which lasts until the end of your next turn. While the barrier holds, the chosen creature gains temporary hit points equal to 4 times your Samurai level, which take as much of the triggering damage as possible. Immediately after the barrier takes damage, the shielded creature's speed is halved, and you can't cast spells except cantrips.

These effects, including any remaining temporary hit points, all end when the barrier dissipates.

You can use this feature twice. You regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

MASTER OF THE MYSTIC ARTS

At 20th level, your *Onmyodo* powers further deepen your influence over the spirits. You can enter a special stance called **Kami**. A graceful stance that channels your spiritual energy through your blade. You can weave in and out of this stance for 1 minute, and it gives you the following benefits:

- When you or your *shikigami* hit a creature with an attack, the creature hit takes additional damage equal to your Samurai level. You can deal this additional damage only once per turn.
- When you make an Intelligence or a Wisdom check or a Constitution saving throw to maintain concentration on a spell, you can treat a roll of 9 or lower on the d20 as a 10.
- You and your *shikigami* have advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

V.1.1 CHANGELOG

MAIN CLASS CHANGES

- Edited certain words to make it more generic.
- Changed multiclassing requirements from 13 Strength **or** Dexterity to 13 Strength **and** Dexterity.
- Added a small featurette for Samurai weapons.
- Changed **Saving Throw** proficiencies from Dexterity and Constitution, to Strength and Constitution.
- Changed **Skill** proficiencies. Removed **Arcana** for **Intimidation**. Removed **Stealth** for **Acrobatics**
- Replaced **Starting equipment** Shortbow, with Longbow.
- Adjusted the duration of **Stance**
- Adjusted the effects of Heaven and Man stance.
- Adjusted **First Step** to not be too strong when multiclassing.
- Added **Archery** and **Elegant Warrior** Fighting Styles.
- Moved half of **Elegant Courtier** to level 2 and the other half to 11th level.
- Removed **Makeshift Medicine**
- Removed **Extra Attack** from the subclass features and included it in the main class features.
- Added a feature at 5th level: **Precise Strike**
- Removed **Harsh Lessons**
- Changed the effects of **Focused Stance**

SUBCLASS CHANGES

BUSHI

- Changed **Warrior Spirit** to **Signature Weapon**
- Moved **Rapid Strike** to 9th level and removed **Tireless Spirit**

SHINOBI

- Adjusted the features gained from Infiltrator
- Reworded **Ninjutsu** to **Implements**
- Added additional feature for poisons under **Guerilla Warfare**

ONMYOJI

- Added a new rule for concentrating on spells and stance.
- Removed ability to add wisdom modifier on cleric cantrips.
- Changed **Shikigami Master** to focus more on your *Shikigami* and moved it to 9th level.
- Moved **Spirit Barrier** to 15th level.

V.1.2 CHANGELOG

MAIN CLASS CHANGES

- Adjusted the wording for some of part of the document.
- Removed concentration for **Stance** and removed their negative effects.
- Adjusted the effects of the **Earth** stance.
- Adjusted the wording for **First Step** and expanded its features.
- Removed **Elegant Warrior** Fighting Style.
- Changed the effects of **Ascended Stance**

SUBCLASS CHANGES

BUSHI

- Adjusted the wording of **Bowmaster**.

- Adjusted the effects of **Mighty Blows**.

SHINOBI

- Adjusted the damage of **Shuriken** in **Potent Ninjutsu**

ONMYOJI

- Removed Giant Eagle from the list of possible familiars.

V.1.3 CHANGELOG

MAIN CLASS CHANGES

- Added Heavy Armor proficiency.
- Changed choice of starting equipment.
- Adjusted the wording of Stance to make it less confusing. Added Affinity definer.
- Adjusted Stance to make it scale off of your Samurai level.
- Limited the usage of **Precise strike**.
- Adjusted the effects of **Ascended Stance - Heaven Kai**.
- Changed to effects of **Ascended Stance - Man Kai**. Activating it now gives you the ability to regain your or another creature's hit points.
- Adjusted the effects of **Unyielding Spirit** to instead give you advantage on Strength and Dexterity saving throws.
- Adjusted the effects of **Strength Before Death**.

SUBCLASS CHANGES

BUSHI

- Adjusted the effects of **Master Duelist**.
- Adjusted the effects of **Mighty Blows** to have a set DC.
- Changed the effects of its level 15 feature.

ONMYOJI

- Adjusted the effects of **Summon Shikigami**.
- Adjusted the HP bonus given to your *Shikigami* by **Shikigami Master**.
- Lowered the scaling of **Spirit Barrier**.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

My utmost gratitude to these wonderful artists, without whom I'm unable to fully express the design ideas that I have for this class.

ARTIST CREDITS

- "Matsu" by Amelie Hutt - artstation
- "Warrior" by SilviuSadoschi - deviantart
- "Samurai Weapon Set VR / AR / low-poly 3d model" by nudelkopf
- "Aftermath" by CaraidArt - deviantart
- "Vagabond" by Conor Smith - artstation
- "Samurai Girl" by River flow shore - artstation
- "Ninja" by AnarchicFox - artstation
- "2019.7" by Carter Adair - artstation
- "Kanetsugu Naoe" by Hiroyuki Suwahara
- "Com: renevene" by Carota17 - deviantart
- "Ichimoku Ren" by Ruiwen Art - artstation

Thanks to these people for their feedback

CREDITS

- u/SamuraiHealer
- u/Highwayman3000
- u/Thrimar
- u/Kalkrex-625
- u/Doctordarkspawn
- u/cubelith
- u/erdtirdmans
- u/Protagonist506
- u/Jakegender
- u/CLiberte
- u/RoiPhi
- u/HKDuskraven
- u/Protagonist506
- u/montezuma300
- u/classroom_doodler